The Owl

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Regis Introduces New STEM Facilities

By Declan Driscoll '28

After months of construction, Regis unveiled its newly renovated fifth floor in September, presenting a major transformation of the school's science, technology, engineering, and mathematics facilities. The extensive revamp, which began in February, was made possible through contributions to Regis's Ready to Do campaign and introduced a new STEAM center along with improvements to its classrooms, student spaces, and advancement ofces.

At the heart of the renovation is the new STEAM center, featuring two natural science labs for biology and chemistry, a flexible lab for physics and engineering, and a new computer science and engineering classroom. The project also included a laboratory preparation room, a rebuilt Science Research Project room, and renovated science and mathematics resource centers. The math resource center now provides access to a new breakout room and conference room, creating additional spaces for collaboration and support.

One of the most significant additions is the new STEAM lab, built in the space previously occupied by the chemistry lecture hall. Equipped with advanced technology, including 3D printers and laser cutters, the lab provides students with new opportunities to engage in projects and experiments. Funding for the equipment was made possible through the contributions to the 2026 Parents' Club Auction, further demonstrating the role of the Regis community in supporting this massive overhaul.

The new facilities are intended to encourage a more interactive way of learning, particularly in the subjects that focus heavily on practical experimentation and problem-solving. The flexible physics and engineering lab, for example, can accommodate a variety of activities, while the new STEAM lab offers resources for students interested in designing and testing their own projects.

Beyond the classrooms themselves, the fifth floor now features two new student gathering spaces, providing areas for students to socialize, study, and collaborate during the school day. The hallways have also received a redesign, incorporating Jesuit-inspired quotes and related imagery into their appearance. Together, these changes have transformed not only the floor's academic facilities but also the environment in which students spend time between classes.

The renovation extended beyond just academic facilities. The Office of Advancement received a rebuilt suite, while the eastern side of the fifth floor saw the addition of a new conference room, faculty restrooms, and the renovation of an existing classroom.

The project represents a signifgcant investment in Regis's infrastructure, especially in STEAM-related fields such as science and mathematics. With new labs, flexible classroom resources, the fifth floor now **CONTINUED ON PAGE 5**

Beautiful Day for Bear Mountain

By Rois Torentino Cobbledick '29

October 2 marked Regis's Bear Mountain Day, and this year certainly did not disappoint! Regians were blessed with wonderful weather: students basked in the sun and enjoyed temperatures up 80 degrees, which provided a well-deserved reprieve from the harsh fall climate. Connor Johnson '30 was extremely excited to participate in this Regis tradition for the first time. During Bear Mountain Day, "you basically do whatever you want" and "be a community, together," Connor shared.

Some of the most exciting events of the year occur at Bear Mountain. One such event is the Kibera Flag Football tournament, in which all players donate $10, and the proceeds go to the St. Aloysius Gonzaga Secondary School in Kibera, Kenya. During the tournament, Regians brought their unrelenting ambition and competitiveness to the field as well as to their wardrobes. One notable team of juniors donned matching all-blank tank tops with taped-on printouts of internet memes. All grades participated in the competition, but seniors Aiden Cha '27, Adam Faughnan '27, Connor Garutti '27, Connor Grasso '27, and Dilan Karim '27 were victorious. While only one team could win, everyone certainly had a great time playing for a wonderful cause.

Another classic Bear Mountain activity was the hike to the top of Bear Mountain. Several students climbed the 1,289 foot mountain, taking in breathtaking views. Evan Colon '29 simply put that his climb to the summit was "exhausting, but it was worth it."

There are always many events planned for students during Bear Mountain Day, but the faculty also joined in the games. Regis faculty competed against their students in the annual Faculty vs. Seniors softball game. Some faculty members, such as Mr. Gallagher '16, himself a former Regis Varsity Baseball player, even spent hours warming up by tossing a ball around for hours and by holding batting practice. Their preparations paid off, as they beat the seniors, winning 14-9.

From riding carousels to playing basketball, from hiking up a mountain to making clutch endzone catches, Bear Mountain was a fantastic start to the school year.





OUT WITH THE OLD, IN WITH THE NEW

Regis Athletics Unveils New Court Design

By Preston Chan '27 and Alessandro Cupido-Carlorosi '27

As Regians trickled back into 84th street for the start of the new school year, they were greeted by a striking transformation: a newly revamped and renovated Upper Gym floor.

Executed over a four-week window from mid-June into mid-July (timing deliberately planned so that the gym would be ready for REACH), the renovation has reformed our main sporting facility.

"The gym being sort of the premier facility that we have, it should be branded appropriately with our new logo," explained Mr. Trigiani, our brand new Athletic Director. It was exactly for this reason why the renovation was even undertaken. With last year's school-wide vote on the new athletics logo, the old "Temple" owl was ready to be replaced.

The response to the aesthetic overhaul has been overwhelmingly positive, especially from the Regis Alumni Basketball league, which was granted a sneak peek shortly after construction had finished. "They were fired up about the floor and how it turned out," noted Mr. Trigiani.

Historically, the Upper Gym ffooring has been waxed and sealed every Thanksgiving weekend to prevent slippage during the basketball and volleyball seasons. However, because the floor was entirely replaced so recently, it was suggested that a coat of wax would not be needed until next summer.

Nevertheless, echoing the widespread concerns voiced by Coach Edwards and Coach Cullen during P.E. classes, Mr. Trigiani made it a point to push for a coat of wax before varsity sports took to the Upper Gym. Another issue had attracted attention as well: the Upper Gym was missing the base lines of the volleyball court.

However, following extensive campaigning by the entire athletic department, the administration approved a waxing and new volleyball lines, to take place while Regians enjoy hearty thanksgiving meals.

The ffoor replacement has also given rise to proposals regarding the future of the other athletic facilities. Both Mr. Trigiani and Mr. Edwards noted that other elements, notably the aging bleachers, air conditioning, and the varsity locker room, could be the next upgrade. "If you're going to do a remodel in your bathroom," Mr. Trigiani joked, "you're not going to leave the old sink and just replace the bathtub." The success of the new upper gym generated aspirations for other possible facility improvements.

However, major overhauls to the rest of the athletic space require patience and institutional balance. As the new Athletic Director, Mr. Trigiani **CONTINUED ON PAGE #**

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Want to write for The Owl

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A Not So New Faculty Member: Mr. Smith

By Alessandro Cupido Carlorosi '27 and Nicholas Szafianski '27

Hailing from the greater Boston area, Mr. Smith is making the commute back to Regis this year. He's going to be in the same office with the same desk, but the nametag outside his door will no longer read "Director of Justice and Service Initiatives." Rather, he's stepping into a new role: Dean of Students.

Before arriving at Regis, Mr. Smith studied American Studies and Sociology at the University of Notre Dame, later getting a Master's in Education from the same school. After finishing college, Mr. Smith went on to explore the more tropical part of the U.S. at IMG Academy in Florida, before returning home to the Northeast. The 2026-2027 school year marks Mr. Smith's fifth year with the Regis Community.

After (unsurprisingly) smashing his application out of Fenway Park, he is now in the right spot to fearmonger the freshmen into wearing their lanyards.

"I've always wanted to be someone that any student can come to," Mr. Smith stated when asked about the favorite part of his new job. "I can get to know all the grades, and not just the Juniors and Seniors doing service. I love being able to communicate with peers and students more frequently."

As his main goal during his first year as Dean, Mr. Smith has outlined that he wants to "make things make sense." The idea, he says, is to encourage clarity and simplicity for everyone, especially regarding the Standard Operating Procedures.

But when 3:00 pm hits, the mean-dean mask melts away. Whenever he can, he loves to play some basketball, run, go to the gym, or roam out and about on the Upper East Side. More relatably, however, he loves a good nap.

Mr. Smith is also an avid music listener, praising R&B, hip-hop, and EDM and artists such as The Weeknd, Drake, and Calvin Harris, whom he met on a trip to Ibiza.

Mr. Smith has also participated in his fair share of trips with Regis. He has chaperoned, among many others, the Madrid Exchange, Jamaica, West Virginia, Ireland, and IFTJ. "I loved these trips," Mr. Smith stated, but he has now decided "to give other teachers the opportunity to experience them too."

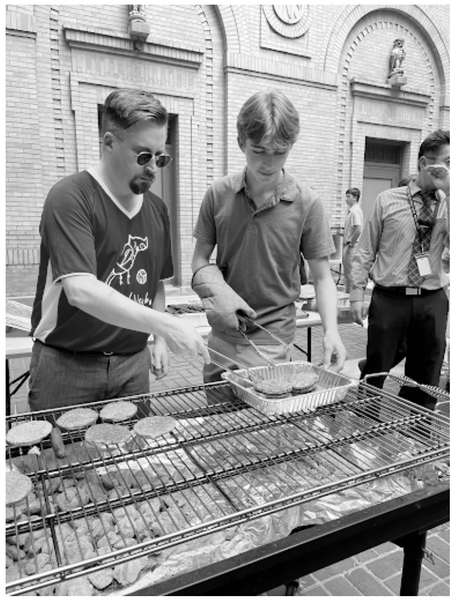
But as long as he continues to ride up and down his favorite MTA line, the Q, we will be sure to get our fair share of Mr. Smith's beaming smile every day. A smile that, he emphasized, he keeps nourished with either free food off the Chick-fil-A app or his home-cooked pasta and chicken (yes, he likes chicken).



Mr. Smith

When asked if there were any parting words he would like to share with the students, Mr. Smith reminded us: "Follow the rules – it's as annoying for me to ask you to do those things as it is for you to hear them," he noted, before offering his signature phrase: "Guys, be men for others, not boys for yourselves."

Student Government Fires Up the Grill



Mr. Rose & Dylan Brennan '27 Grilling Patties

By Ryan Keum ' 29

As the school year ramped up, so did Student Gov. On Thursday, September 17, the Student Government hosted a buzzing barbecue filled with socializing, burgers, and cookies. Starting in August, the Executive Board worked closely with both the cafeteria staff and Mr. Mariano.

The barbecue required strong teamwork between Student Government members. Members split their roles, focusing on being a runner (taking food and drinks to/from the cafeteria), working the grill with Mr. Mariano, and serving the food to students. Junior Class President Lucas Allen helped distribute the burgers and hot dogs. He stated that he "thought the Student Government BBQ was a great way for the whole school to get together at the beginning of the year. It really showed us how food can bring everyone together."

Beyond the food, the barbecue gave students a chance to mingle amongst each other. Thomas Mecane, under the alias of DJ Pink Panini, DJ'd the event. For a full hour, the Quad was buzzing with students eating and socializing. Sophomore Sebastian Marks stated that this event was a "great community bonding experience with great food and amazing vibes. It was good to be able to chill with friends." With an endless supply of burgers, hot dogs, and cookies, what reason did students have to leave?

On the day of the barbecue, both JV and Varsity Regis soccer teams played a doubleheader against Xavier. As a result, many barbecue attendees were soccer players and members of the Nest who watched both games. JV soccer player Luke Fedyna, who had to travel from the barbecue to the game, said that the "barbecue experience got the team hyped up before their game."

With so many students turning out for the barbecue, this event gave the entire Regis community an energetic start to the year and gave the Student Government an early success.



Mr. Trigiani & Mr. Rose Working the Grill

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A Recap of the Kino Border Initiative Immersion

By Luiz Takata'28

Over the summer, ten Regians traveled to Nogales, a town split between Arizona and Mexico. After arriving at the sweltering 110-degree Phoenix airport, we spent a night in a hotel. The next day, we began a lengthy van ride to Nogales. Though we were nervous about the unfamiliar environment, we were eager to learn. We crossed the Arizona-Mexico border, where the Kino Border Initiative welcomed us with a Mass and orientation. We left with many questions about the situation at the border, but now understood the foundational pillars of the trip: to humanize, accompany, and complicate.

As the first full day began, we focused on empathizing with the migrants. We served food and shared meals with them. We heard many stories: one man shared that he had lived in the U.S. for his entire life before being deported on charges he received when he was a teenager, he was then later abused by ICE officers. Another shared that he was separated from his family that lived in Arizona, and a third shared that he attempted a crossing after he was threatened by criminal groups. These stories gave us a greater understanding of the circumstances surrounding migration.



Regis Students at the border between Mexico and the United States.

The next day, we crossed to the Mexican side again to serve breakfast and speak with the locals. We continued to immerse ourselves through a tour of downtown Nogales, Sonora. The tour began with an authentic Mexican lunch, and we learned about the wall's impact on the town. We also heard stories of crossings, including that of Jose Antonio, who was shot and killed by a U.S. Border Patrol officer for throwing rocks past the wall.

We visited the Arizona District Court in Tucson to explore opposing perspectives. We arrived at the courthouse and encountered a group of detainees in shackles. During the proceedings, the judge asked them if they would like to plead guilty, which they all did with the aid of a translator. As the first set of hearings ended, a public defender offered to speak to us privately. She explained that her clients rarely go to trial as they face an American jury without a lawyer being provided for them. Then they face another hearing regarding their immigration status. We returned to the courtroom to speak to the judge and prosecutor. As we expected, the prosecutor and judge both defended the system but affirmed that they were committed to maintaining justice in the migration process. The interaction taught us that perspective is integral to understanding the nuances of the immigration crisis in the United States.

"Kino is an eye-opening experience that makes us dive deeper into questions and problems that we thought had a simple solution."

During the final days of the trip, we crossed back into Mexico, where our focus shifted to service. We continued to grow close to the community in Kino, having more personal conversations with the adults and playing games with the children. In addition to service work, we attended several presentations covering topics such as the asylum process, the history of immigration policy, and the origins of the Kino Border Initiative.

The Kino Border Initiative trip challenged us to reconcile the nuances of the immigration crisis, offering us human perspectives coupled with knowledge that allowed us to see the human realities of migration beyond statistics and policy. Logan Moran '28 reflected, "Kino is an eye-opening experience that makes us dive deeper into questions and problems that we thought had a simple solution." That sense of complexity was also reflected by Antonio Takata '26, a Regis alum who went on Kino twice and led our Kino Teens Club. He shared "Kino was a transformative journey, blending moments of learning, empathy, and shared joy, creating an experience that we will carry with us for the rest of our lives."

From 84th Street to the Seine: A look into the Paris Exchange

By Martyn Hewryk'28

When the World Cup started this summer, ten Regis students were not watching from home; rather, they watched from Paris–the heart of France–as part of a two week exchange. The students were paired up and stayed in the households of ten students from Lycée Saint-Louis-de-Gonzague, more commonly known as Franklin, a highly selective Jesuit school founded in 1894 that is ranked among the top schools in all of France. The school is located in the 16th arrondissement, which is known for having some of the best views of the Eiffel Tower.

Each morning Regis students and their French partners met at Franklin to start the program organized by the chaperones of the trip. This included a biking excursion to Monet's house and gardens at Giverny as well as visits to two classic and contemporary art museums: the Louvre and the Palais de Tokyo. Additionally, the students participated in a self-guided scavenger hunt and exploration of Montmartre and the Latin Quarter. Students had the opportunity to visit historical sights like Napoleon's Tomb, the Gardens of Versailles, and the Catacombs under Paris. When asked about the various places the students visited, Lucas Jimenez-Chavez '28 said, "I enjoyed the Gardens of Versailles because of their natural beauty and historical significance."

Along with the various museums that the group visited, there were other activities that focused more on immersing the Regis students in French culture. The chaperones organized a lunch where all the Americans were encouraged to try traditional French dishes. Most Regians chose to have ratatouille: a dish they were excited to try because of the Pixar movie set in Paris. There were also activities that required Regis students to use their knowledge of French to interact with other Parisians by conducting street interviews and ordering pastries from a boulangerie. Coming back to school in the fall, Ben Schestag '28 says the trip changed the way he speaks French. "Before the trip I would freeze up when someone spoke to me quickly, but by the second week I could understand much better and was ordering at cafes without even thinking about it."

Apart from the scheduled program which ran from 9 a.m. to 4 p.m., students spent much time with their exchange partners visiting other things that Paris has to offer. Students visited the famous Galeries Lafayette department store, and spent many evenings by the Seine catching great views of Paris at night. The students were also able to enjoy watching the World Cup with one of the most passionate fanbases in the tournament. When asked his favorite moment from the trip, Tchuisse Kamwa '28 said, "I really liked having so much freedom to explore with my exchange partner because he showed me all of his favorite food spots."



Regians on the French exchange gather for a sunny photo.

The trip was an incredible experience for the students who had the opportunity to explore French language and culture in a new depth. They also grew closer during their trip, forming great friendships with their exchange partners and other Parisians.

Even though the students are back home with their own families, the exchange is not over yet. In a few weeks, the French students will fly to New York and Regians will be the ones showing off their favorite food spots.

Freshman Get Their First Taste of Debate: Glimpses of the Hearn



Freshman Gather in the Auditorium for Insight From the Upperclassmen

By Luiz Takata '28

As the school year loomed, incoming freshmen crowded into the auditorium, eager to discover one of Regis' most prominent co-curriculars. The Summer Glimpses of the Hearn introduces freshmen to the Hearn: Speech & Debate Society through conversations with upperclassmen and student performances.

The student performances began soon after the freshman spoke with upperclassmen. The exhibition started with the expressive side of the Hearn: forms of speech and acting. CJ Ackermann '29 performed a piece on taking risks, using the performance itself as an example of a risk. Ackermann was a top-ranked speaker in the nation last year. Then Paul Frimpong-Manso '28 performed the famous "I Have a Dream" speech by Martin Luther King Jr. Paul was the national champion last year with this speech, and his intense oration impressed the incoming class. These performances aim to give students a taste of what they will be doing in the Hearn, encouraging them to join and learn the same skills as those performing.

Following these performances, prospective Hearnsters got a glimpse of the intellectual categories: debate and extemporaneous speech. The performances began with Aidan Shrekgast's extemporaneous speech. The category is based on speaking with limited preparation for a topic, forcing students to have a general knowledge about global events. His speech centered around necessary actions for Democrats to win the midterms. Without any preparation outside of thirty minutes before, Aidan performed an eloquent and informative speech. The next performance introduced the debate category. Two teams of William Keller and Harrison Anderson versus Andrew Moszuti and Alessandro Cupido Carlorosi debated a past topic on whether the United Kingdom should rejoin the European Union. Their various speeches, focused on either argument or rebuttal, gave students a new glimpse of the knowledge gained through years in the Hearn.

The event continues to attract incoming students to one of Regis' largest co-curriculars. As the Hearn begins the school year, students revisit the event as their first exposure to the program. Warren Kasman '28 offered his reflection, "The Glimpses of the Hearn is an amazing demonstration of how committed Regis students are to excelling outside of the classroom, and a great opportunity for freshmen to begin to see how much Regis truly has to offer."

Meet Ms. Bolivar: Regis' New Director of Service and Justice

By Alessandro Cupido Carlorosi '27 & Nicholas Szafianski '27

As Mr. Smith made his way into the Dean's office, Regis looked long and far for someone to fill the position of Director of Service and Justice Initiatives. In his wake, Ms. Bolivar took up the vacant office.

Though a new face, she is certainly not new to this role. After an upbringing near Boston (frequenting the same parish as Mr. Smith), she attended high school in Arizona before enrolling at the University of Notre Dame (following once again in Mr. Smith's footsteps). There, she initially studied to become a high school English teacher, but soon switched her major to Education Studies.

But many times in life, it's the small things that impact us the most. For Ms. Bolivar, it was her minor in Poverty Studies. Though just a 15-credit course requirement, its true value lay in the service learning opportunities it opened her up to. In the past few years, she worked for an elementary school in Brooklyn and Beacon High School in Hell's Kitchen, all the while studying for her Master's degree at Columbia's Teachers College. At those high schools, she took up counseling jobs that she never would have discovered if not for her spiritual learning through service. Having graduated with a Master's this May, she was immediately drawn to the familiar and welcoming community and environment at Regis.

"I really appreciate getting the opportunity to be in a space students can hang out in," Ms. Bolivar stated, reminiscing about the favorite parts of her new position. "You don't get that as a teacher…as a teacher, you just get work done and leave. Here, it's up to the students to seek you out." And of course, she loves spending time with her best friend, Ms. Dallam.

Settling into her new desk and Ms. Dallam's makeshift book club, Ms. Bolivar explained her job: "I work in a school with only boys. I help them help other people." At the same time, she realizes the importance of learning as much as possible and hopes to uphold the legacy built by Mr. Smith and Ms. Dallam.

When asked about her main goal for her first year at Regis, Ms. Bolivar explained that she wants "to help students tap into service that means more than just completing hours." Service should be a transformative experience in countless different ways, and it is her job, she says, to help us make the most of those very experiences.

Though director of Service, Ms. Bolivar's own life extends far past the boundaries of the school. Now a resident of the West Side of Manhattan, she enjoys walks in Central Park to unwind after a busy day. To the joy of Mr. Simon, she also loves Ultimate Frisbee.

Ms. Bolivar is also an avid reader, already settling into a makeshift book club with Ms. Dallam. Among her favorite books are The Poisonwood Bible and Little Women. When she needs a break from reading, she turns to the TV series Friends or her favorite movie, the Lindsay Lohan version of The Parent Trap.

When she isn't roaming Central Park or Riverside, Ms. Bolivar also enjoys travelling. She has spent the last four summers in Ireland, marking Westport as her favorite destination. Closer to home, she can be found riding her beloved 2 and 3 trains downtown to Malatesta, her favorite restaurant in the West Village.

Ms. Bolivar's parting message to Regians is that she wants students to know one thing above all: she "cares about you."



Ms. Bolivar joined Regis this fall as Director of Service and Justice Initiatives.

Two Truths & a Lie:

With that, we'd like to leave our readers with a game of 2 truths, 1 lie (feat. Ms. Bolivar):

1. She shaved her head bald and donated her hair as a freshman in college
2. She has a pilot's license
3. She lived in a foreign country

To find out the correct answer, go visit her in the Belonging, Dignity, and Justice Office!

Adventures in West Virginia: Regis' trip to Wheeling, WV

By Evan Colon '29 & Kenta Fujii '29

During Regis' extended summer break, a group of 18 Regians and 3 chaperones visited the Wheeling Area in Northern West Virginia and Western Pennsylvania. Over the six day trip students learned about the history of the region and participated in service projects across the Wheeling Area. Students gained an insight into life in a place much more rural and less fortunate than the city we call home.

The trip began on Sunday, July 19th. All 21 volunteers packed into two cramped vans and embarked on the 7 hour journey to the Appalachian Mountains. The group arrived in downtown Wheeling after a long day of traveling. They took scenic pictures along the Ohio river and on the Wheeling Suspension Bridge, the first bridge built west of the Appalachian Mountains. While doing so the group tried the famous DiCarlo's Pizza, though some questioned why it is such a Wheeling staple. Next, the group headed to where they would be staying for the week, the Fresh Air Farms, just 15 minutes outside of downtown Wheeling. The unit included a full kitchen, as well as 2 restrooms. The group headed to sleep at 9:30, ready for the day ahead of them.

The next morning the group freshened up and headed downstairs to prepare their lunch for the day. Shortly after they gathered themselves in the downstairs room to get a history lesson on West Virginia and to learn of their Itinerary of the week from West Virginian native Tom Brieding. Tom taught the history of West Virginia, through song and spoken words. He mentioned the importance that West Virginia had and has on the entire nation. Student Jake Nardella '29 mentioned feeling "Inspired by Tom's passion in the history of West Virginia, and in spreading awareness for the importance of the state of America as a whole." Following this, the group aided in helping a farm in Pennsylvania prevent the spread of invasive grass species, called stillgrass. The group next embarked on a tour of a coal mine, led by Tom, where he explained how they work, and how they negatively impact the local environment. Finally, the group headed to Fresh Air Farms to cook spaghetti and meatballs before heading to bed for the night.



A group of Regians, tired, but fulfilled from a hard days work.

Tuesday morning began similarly to Monday, with a lesson from Tom on West Virginian history. The group learned of the Battle of Blair Mountain, which, outside of the Civil War, was the biggest armed uprising in the nation's history, and revolved around issues regarding the violent working conditions of coal miners and the prevention of the miners to form a worker's union. Following this the group headed to the Soup Kitchen of Greater Wheeling, where they volunteered in serving food to the underprivileged and in reorganizing the large supply of food in the kitchen. That night, the group dined with St. Xavier High School who came from Cincinnati Ohio. Students from both schools interacted, comparing the vastly different cultures of the two major cities.

Wednesday morning started off with a later start than the days prior, allowing the group to catch up on missed sleep. Students made a breakfast of bacon and eggs before heading to a garden meant to give the visually impaired working opportunities. By pulling out weeds and placing down mulch the students made sure the work went smoothly for the workers. Following this the students were given a tour of downtown wheeling by Tom, and were joined by St. Xavier. Students were interested in the rich history the town had to offer. They visited both a theatre and revisited the suspension bridge, this time with Tom teaching them of the bridge. Later that night, the group made delicious tacos. Then the group gathered around a fireplace to make smores, and participate in fun outdoor games, including sparring with plastic baseball bats.. After a delicious dinner and tiring games the group headed to sleep.

On Thursday the group helped move hundreds of boxes filled with basic necessities for the West Virginia Christmas Project. Though tiring, the students got to refresh at the Wheeling community pool or by playing board games outside. Finally the group ate at Primanti Bros, a famous sandwich chain which originated in Pittsburg. The group spent their final night cleaning up the house, including the restrooms and the sleeping area. The group fell asleep tired from the day ahead, sad to be at the end of their journey, and excited to return home the next day.

Friday began with an early leaving time from Fresh Air Farms, and a two hour drive to the final service site of the trip in Pennsylvania. The group would pick weeds and waste at the site, and were then given a tour of the beautiful Fallingwater Mansion built on a waterfall. Lastly the group headed back to New York on a 6 hour car ride home, finally arriving in the city at 8pm. Students and Chaperones alike walked away from the trip with new friends, new experiences, and a new outlook on a place so different from New York.

First Freshman Look: A Glance Into Freshman Orientation

By Mike Bonafede '28

On September 9th, Regis welcomed the Class of 2030 to begin their high school career on 84th Street!

Orientation began with a meeting in the Quad. Students met their classmates, advisors, and Jaspers for the first time. As Paco Gomez-Villava '28 put it, "Being back in the Quad reminded me of my first day at Regis, and I was glad to be able to help others who were in the same position as I was in two years ago". After introducing themselves to their advisement in the Quad, freshmen headed over to the Chapel of the Sacred Heart, where they participated in a brief prayer service along with the singing of the Alma Mater. From there, students got to know one another better through icebreaker activities in their advisement locations. They also were introduced to the expectations of attending Regis.

The afternoon kicked off with lunch, followed by a Mass in the chapel. Jaspers modeled the different roles available for students to participate in at Mass, including being an altar server, Eucharistic minister, or lector.

From there, freshmen participated in a scavenger hunt. Going from the second floor to the fifth floor, from the MRC all the way to the Lower Gym, students were led to all the main areas of the school. "It was a fun way to start to learn my way around the school', said Luca Bonafede '30.

To cap off the first day, freshmen and their families joined for the Freshman Family Barbecue. This was an awesome time where families were able to meet others from places all over the tri-state area and enjoy some delicious food after a tiring first day of orientation.

On the second day, students met all of their teachers and were introduced to each of their courses for the year. Teachers emphasized the importance of asking for help and making use of the support system Regis has to offer. The day concluded with the praying of the Examen, offering a time for freshmen to reflect on their first two days of orientation and look ahead to the exciting school year ahead.



Freshman bond over icebreaker activites

New STEM Facilities

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provides many additional opportunities for hands-on learning and collaboration between different subjects. These improvements also support students pursuing interests such as computer science, engineering, and other scientific research beyond their standard coursework.

Completed over the course of approximately seven months, the transformation of the fifth floor marks a new chapter for one of the school's most important academic spaces. As students and teachers continue to make use of the new facilities, the renovation stands as a result of the generosity of the Regis community and its investment in the school's future.

New Court

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has emphasized that his primary focus right now is learning the landscape, listening to the community, and advocating thoughtfully for Regis athletics while respecting the decisionmaking process and broader needs of the school, from the performing arts to academic spaces.

"A rising tide lifts all boats," Mr. Trigiani reflected. "My job is to make sure the athletic department is as great as it can be…but it's about being the best we can be, beyond just collecting titles."

For now, Regians can enjoy the new court flooring underfoot before yet another overhaul, setting the stage for what are shaping up to be successful volleyball and basketball seasons.

雷吉斯在中国 (Regis in China / Léi jí sī zài zhōngguó)

By Mark Fedyna '28

This past June, fifteen Regians and four Dominican Academy students traveled to southeastern China on a cultural and language immersion trip. Through the China Institute of America, Discover China in Jinhua International Youth Exchange Program, and the Ricci Scholars Program, the students spent two weeks visiting sites across Zhejiang and Jiangsu Provinces, experiencing the full breadth of Chinese culture.

The Ricci Scholars program, established in 2019, was inspired by the real-life relationship between Italian Jesuit Matteo Ricci and Chinese scholar Xu Guangqi during the early 17th century Ming Dynasty. The unlikely friendship sprouted as a result of their shared goals of using both Eastern and Western thought to better the world. Fueled by these ideals of intercultural exchange, the program consists of scholars from member schools in China and America such as Regis High School, Dominican Academy, and Nanjing Foreign Language School.

On June 13th, The Ricci cohort departed from JFK on an 18 hour flight to Hong Kong after which they flew to Shanghai. Upon arrival, they were introduced to Ricci organizer Ms. Wei, and spent the first two days touring the vibrant city of Shanghai. Students not only experienced Chinese history at the Shanghai Museum and the vintage 450 year old Yu Garden, but they also toured the glittering Shanghai Bund with its vibrant nightlife.

On day 3, they stayed at the traditional 1300 year old Chinese water town of Wuzhen. And then on day 4 the students found themselves braving the intense heat and humidity of Hangzhou's famous West Lake.

On day 5, the group visited the famous Jing An Buddhist Temple. Later, the Ricci Scholars were introduced to the Discover China in Jinhua International Youth Exchange Program at Zhejiang Normal University. The program brought high school and college students from countries like Russia, South Africa, France, America, and China to Jinhua in order to facilitate intercultural dialogue and connection.

On day 6, the students visited the Panda Pig integrated theme park, participated in science experiments and even played a football match against a competitive Jinhua girls team at the ZJNU football stadium. Even the mayor of Jinhua joined in on the action, competing on b o t h sides.

Day 7 saw the Ricci Scholars visiting Hengidian World Studios to film a musical about Matteo Ricci. Then on day 8 the group visited the trade city of Yiwu to learn about Chinese commerce. With the help of Yiwu Quxing International School Students, the Regians roamed the never ending floors of the Yiwu International Trade City in search of deals and knowledge about Chinese goods. From June 19th-21st, China celebrated their annual Dragon Boat Festival commemorating the ancient poet Qu Yuan. The cohort lined the banks of a river in Zhejiang province to watch the multicolored boats cut through the water to the beat of drums.

The Jinhua exchange program culminated on day 9 in a massive forum event where Regians, Dominican Academy students, and Chinese politicians alike all presented to a crowd of over 200.

On day 10, the students traveled via bullet train from Zhejiang province to Jiangsu province to meet the students of NFLS. Regians met their "homestay" families and became acquainted with their new homes for the next four days.

The next day Ricci Scholars learned the practice of tai chi and visited a museum dedicated to traditional Chinese medicine. The following days of



Ricci Scholars in China

the trip saw the Ricci Scholars and students of NFLS truly connect and build relationships. They crossed the great Yangzhe river and visited a Chinese transit exhibition. Late in the evenings, many American students went out to dinner with their new Chinese friends in Laomendong after walking on the Ming Dynasty era city walls.

Day 14 was the last day that the Ricci Scholars spent in Nanjing but for some, it was one of the most memorable. After the closing ceremony held at NFLS, many students hiked up Zijin Shan (Purple Mountain) towering 1,400 feet. Later, they went to dinner in Shinjiekou and experienced its vibrant night atmosphere. The last day was spent in the antique gardens of Suzhou.

Whether it be practicing Chinese while ordering at a restaurant or dining with their homestays during a family meal in Nanjing, the Ricci Scholars 2026 cohort truly immersed themselves in the fascinating world of China.

A New Face in the TRC: Dr. Smytsnyuk



Photo of Dr. Smytsnyuk

By Mark Fedyna '28

This fall, the TRC welcomed a new member to its fabled cast of teachers, Dr. Pavlo Smytsnyuk. He has spent time studying and teaching all around the world before landing behind a desk on East 84th Street, where he teaches Sophomore, Junior, and Senior Theology classes.

Dr. Smytsnyuk truly embodies a worldwide education, as he grew up in post-Soviet Ukraine near the city of Lviv. First studying theology at a Jesuit institution in Rome, he then jetted across the Ionian Sea to Athens, where he focused on studying Orthodox Christianity. Lastly, he studied for his Ph.D. at Campion Hall, Oxford's Jesuit institution.

Before landing at Regis, Dr. Smytsnyuk taught at the Ukrainian Catholic University in Lviv. After his time at the university, he completed fellowships at Princeton, The George Washington University, and New York University. At these institutions, he focused on the relationship between religion and war, as well as political theology. Especially after the full-scale invasion of Ukraine, pragmatic questions such as whether Christians may be permitted to kill in self-defense became immediate.

When asked why he chose to come to Regis, Dr. Smytsnyuk pointed to Regis's tuition-free policy, noting it as"almost revolutionary." The Jesuit tradition at Regis also caught Dr. Smytsnyuk's attention, as he does not want his students to simply become "paper writing machines." Instead, he wants them to embody the Jesuit idea of cura personalis. His biggest observation of the Regis community came at the assembly for the Fall Convocation. He noticed that all the students were sitting in the seats while the teachers were standing to the side; while it may seem to be a small organizational detail, Dr. Smytsnyuk felt that it highlighted the emphasis that Regis puts on the students as the center of the community.

Dr. Smytsnyuk admitted that in thirty years, his students will likely forget most of the material from class. To him, that material is like baking paper: the surface on which the real intellectual work gets done. What he hopes will remain are the skills: critical thinking, close reading, and arguing well.

Finally, Dr. Smytsnyuk's advice to all Regians is simple: "read with a pencil." He believes this is fundamental to understanding a text and being able to engage it. As a scholar who studied across three continents, Dr. Smytsnyuk brings a world of perspective to Regis. Please stop by his desk and ask him about his travels and welcome him to the Regis community!

The Regis Freshman Survival Guide, From a Friendly Senior

By Matthew Nunez '27

It's been about one month since the school year started. The class of 2030 has already taken their first tests, the first couple of assemblies have been attended, and we've already gone on our annual trip to Bear Mountain. Now many young students may be overwhelmed and alienated by the environment they now find themselves in—I know I had my share of troubles in my first year here. It can be stressful being in such a foreign environment for some students, and the academic rigor of the classes is no help either.

Thankfully, you new students are not alone. This short guide is meant to provide a list of helpful tips and reminders for any student struggling to find their place at Regis, taking from my own personal experience as someone who's had his own difficulties with the school, as well as tips from fellow seniors.

1. Study hard and often

Regis is a highly academically rigorous school. As such, it's important to study and take notes at every opportunity. In my experience, I never had to study until I came to Regis. Tests and quizzes will come hard and fast, so taking that extra time to ensure that you really do understand the topic is crucial for maintaining your grades (and your self-esteem). Use every strategy in the book, from building Quizlet flashcards to "blurbing" to last-minute study guides. If a class asks you to annotate, then do so, and make sure you make your annotations clear and understandable at a glance for future use. You never know when Ms. Fitle will give you an annotation check on a long reading

2. Use resources

Regis is great at providing its students with any resource they might need to succeed. Don't be afraid to use them. Resource centers are wonderful for meeting up with students and teachers to discuss class material and gain a further understanding of anything you may have missed. Every teacher has offce hours at least once a week: take advantage of them! Services like math tutoring and writing counseling are also amazing resources:they're wonderful for reinforcing what you've learned in class or getting a second set of eyes on your work for tips. There are plenty of other resources available to you that I'm neglecting to mention, so don't be afraid to look around and ask for help

3. Don't focus exclusively on school

The school hosts a whole host of clubs, sports, and activities and you should make it one of your priorities to be active in at least two or three of them. These extracurricular groups are wonderful ways to de-stress, have fun during the school day and make new friends. I've participated with the theatre crew for two years, and during my time there I've made a lot of friends between fellow crewmembers and actors on the plays I've helped with. It's also a fun experience in its own right. Take a look at the club list every once in a while displayed on the TVs and go to the ones that interest you the most.

In addition, the school also holds many events and parties throughout the year. These are great opportunities to meet with friends in a non-academic context and enjoy yourself. You should make an effort to go to at least one such gathering.

Of course, these three points aren't the only things to keep in mind as you go about your time here at Regis, but they are among the most important. Remember these and your time here will go quite smoothly.



Members of the Class of 2030 gather around a table during their first weeks at Regis.

Teaching Across Time Zones: Regians in Malaysia

By Harrison Anderson '27

Every week, late at night in New York, Regis students log onto Zoom to teach children in Kuala Lumpur, where it is already morning. This July, seven of them boarded a plane to meet their students in person.

The trip sends students to the Zotung Refugee Catholic Learning Centre for a week of teaching. Founded in 2008, the center now serves more than 120 children, many refugees from Myanmar.

Catalyst started the initiative in November 2020, when Regis students were stuck at home. Daniel and Samuel Ngiam '23, who had volunteered with Zotung since middle school, built the program quickly. The time difference helped their efforts: 10p.m. in New York is 10a.m. in Kuala Lumpur.

What began as video conversations has become more structured. "We're better at what we do. We have a curriculum now," said Mr. Rose, moderator of Zotung and leader of the trip. Aspiring volunteers must shadow classes and team-teach before leading before leading a class of their own. As Zotung shifts resources toward older students preparing for exams, Regis volunteers mostly teach younger children in classes of one or two, which lets relationships build over time in tight knit groups.

Many Burmese refugees once passed through Kuala Lumpur on the way to other countries, but as resettlement programs have shrunk, more are staying. Malaysia has no public requirement to educate non-citizen children, so refugee schools have sprung up across the city, and many families lack legal status and face risks like extortion and deportation. Thus is the need for steady, passionate Regis teacher volunteers.

Classes are built around English, sometimes in a disguise: a lesson on restaurant habits is really immersion learning. "The end goal of all of this is that with English skills, they can find alternative pathways to lead successful and wonderful lives," Mr. Rose shares.

This year's group travelled with Dr. Baldassarri and prepared more than in the past, with Saturday training sessions and curriculum planning. They also spent a day teaching at the Zoe School, another Chin refugee school, which showed Regians how much more acute poverty can be elsewhere. Some of its doors are wooden boards propped up across the entrance. In the evenings, the group visited students' homes, where they had the opportunity to connect with the student's families and be immersed in traditional Malaysian culture.

According to co-chairperson Connor Garutti '27, "nothing makes [him] happier than seeing how much [his] students improve and seeing how hard they work."

Connor's experience gave him insight into teaching that he couldn't gather on Zoom. He shared that he and other Regians are ready and excited to bring back what they have learned in Malaysia to make their classes even more effective. That is why the trip to Malaysia is not a senior-year capstone. Usually, sophomores and juniors join, because what they learn in Kuala Lumpur improves their teaching when they return. "I view it as part of a cycle," said Mr. Rose.

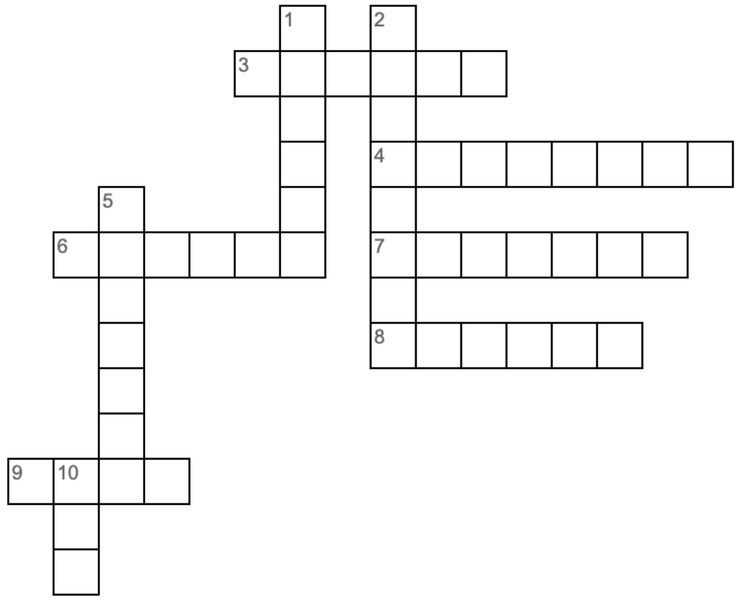
For Mr. Rose, a highlight was watching students take charge of class: "seeing guys getting up in front of the room, and they're actually doing the thing!" Another was Dr. Baldassarri making pasta, using Coke cans as rolling pins.

Back in New York, Regians resume their late-night classes even more enthusiastically than before. Patrick McKnight '28 speaks on behalf of the entire trip, saying "we all feel really energized now, even more than before. We're looking forward to the year to come. We've seen the change we can make in their lives."



Dr. Baldassari makes pasta with a Malaysian student

REGIS CROSSWORD



Across

3 Club Meeting Offerings
4 New Athletics Director Mr. ___
6 Junior Advisor?
7 Take ___
8 End of Day Event
9 Regis Rep Production 'Sweeney ___"

Down

1 Fall Ball Sport
2 Feature of Mr. Gunn and Mr. Cubi
5 Regis Neck Attire
10 Animal on Upper Gym Floor

By Xavier Neptune '27

Turn upside down for answers!

Down
1: SOCCER
2: MUSTACHE
5: LANYARD
10: OWL

Across
3: DONUTS
4: TRIGIANI
6: JASPER
7: COURAGE
8: EXAMEN
9: TODD

REGIS CONNECTIONS

MASS	WALKATHON	CUBIC	CONVOCATION
BOOKS	CHRISTMAS AT REGIS	GREEN FLAG	ASSEMBLY
ROSEBUD	LATE START	PRINTER	POWER
QUEST	BEAR MOUNTAIN DAY	GUNNER	MR. LAWSON

By Xavier Neptune '27

Scan the QR code for the answers!

Editor's Note

Welcome back, Regians. The Owl is officially back in print, and we wanted to thank a few people for all of their help. First, thank you to Mr. Thiemann, as the creation of the Newsroom class this year has helped tremendously in bringing the paper back. Without his time and guidance, this issue would not exist. We also want to thank all of the seniors who are a part of the Newsroom, helping with writing, editing, and laying out these pages.

A newspaper is only as strong as the people who write for it. If you are a freshmen or sophomore, you don't need any experience, you just need an opinion about something happening at Regis or in the world. We're starting new columns like Current Events and Regians in the Real World, and we'd love to hear your ideas. Juniors interested in editing should reach out too, since you'll be leading The Owl next year. If you have an idea, reach out or find one of us in the hallway.

Sincerely,
Gabriele Troiano, Andrew Klimczak, and William Keller
Co-Editors-in-Chief, The Owl

The Class of 2030





















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